

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 6
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ Reawakening to What Our Souls Already Know
11 October 2026

COMMUNION

Preaching: ML

Worship Leading: Emily Kang, Gavin Gregorio, and LVF

Tech needs: one solo microphone

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Laura and ... to center chancel]

Welcome

LVF

Words of Gathering

LVF &...

Fountain of life...

Pulse of life...

Breath of life...

Earth is filled with the presentness of God.

A planet filled with the presence of God

a living green blue planet,

people from every corner of creation,

the vast reaches of space above us,

and the rocks and hills and wonders of the wild.

Together this day,

let us sense and feel

the face of God in all creation.

Together this day,

let us celebrate the life-giving

breath of our God.

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

Creator God You Gave Us Life

OLD HUNDREDTH

Creator God, you gave us life,
your image formed within our souls,
yet through the mist of time and space,
we search for that which makes us whole.

Through hands that paint majestic skies,
and voices chanting melody,
with words that reach beyond the page,
we comprehend your mystery.

In every flow'r and every tree,
we see your great diversity,
yet greater still we see your love,
expressed in our humanity.

When with our hearts,
our hands our minds,
we share our gifts with all the world,
our spirits soar beyond the veil,
to touch the very face of God.

[Laura center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness

LVF

We pray:

***Creating God, whose renewing breath fills our planet,
may we discern your vibrant, creative presence among us.
And may our spirits be lifted
as we rejoice with Earth
and all its inhabitants, this day.
Amen and Amen!***

OR

God of love, show us our place in this world
as channels of your love
for all the creatures of this earth -
for not one of us is forgotten in your sight.

Enlighten those who possess power and money
that they may avoid indifference,
that they may love the common good,
advance the weak,
and care for this world
in which we live.

The poor, the oppressed, and the earth
are crying out.

So we ask, Good and Gracious God, seize us with your power,
with your beautiful darkness, with your amazing light,
and help us to protect all life,
with all that we have and all that we are
as we work for your kin-dom
of justice, peace, love, and beauty.

-adapted from the Pope's Encyclical, 2015

Amen and Amen.

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

Iona Alleluia

TRADITIONAL CELTIC

Frank Hobbs, *Soloist*, Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

From the Island of Iona

[...to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Laura center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

LVF

As we share this ancient greeting,
we invite you to offer signs of peace to one another with a bow
- a gesture used broadly across many cultures
as a sign of greeting, respect, honor, humility, and love.
This morning, may it be an expression
of the intention of the peace with which we long to live
with one another, the world, and all creation.

For the gift of this new day
for waking again from the dreams of the night
for our bodies strengthened and our minds renewed
Thanks be to you, O God.

You are the stillness of the night,

you are the genesis of the morning
you are the dew of new creation.

***Let there be peace in the human soul
let there be waking to new consciousness***

In the life of the world this day
and in our hearts
let there be fresh hope for peace.

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[... to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition *from*

This is the witness of the ancients...
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition Laura to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

LVF

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Each one of us knows things in the core of our being
that we have not necessarily been taught,
and some of this deep knowing may actually
be at odds with what our society or religion
has tried to teach us.

In this time, in this brave space we call home,
we are being invited to reawaken
to what we know in the depths of our being -
that the earth is sacred and that this sacredness
is at the heart of every human being and life-form.

As we are now in silence together,
let us breathe in this sacred space
knowing that God is with us
in this time and place. [jphilipnewell]

Silence

[Christoph plays transition out of silence]

Prayer of our Hearts

Creator Spirit,
we give thanks that your life-giving Presence
has been active in our universe for all the billions of years
that have passed since the first moments of its existence.

Working within and with what was there,
your Presence came to visible expression
in the formation of stars
and galaxies
and planets.

Rocks and grasses,
water and soil,
all living things, including us,
came to life with a conscious
awareness and appreciation
of your Presence.

Help us on this day
to marvel at this life,
as we continue to embrace
this Sacred Earth we call home.

*Help us on this day
to celebrate the Source of all that is
and of all that shall be. Amen.* [mmorwood/adapt]

[Christoph transition for Choir]

Meditation Anthem This Little Light of Mine
TRADITIONAL AFRICAN-AMERICAN SPIRITUAL
ARR. MOSES HOGAN
Lorenzo Zapata, *Soloist*, Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

[Christoph transition Michael to pulpit]

Sermon *Reawakening to What Our Souls Already Know* **ML**

[Christoph transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

We are drawn together by the Wisdom of the universe,
nature's intelligence,
embodied in Jesus
and present in all souls
who gather at Wisdom's table.

*We gather to receive grace to give up our foolish ways,
to walk in Wisdom's light,
to delight in creation and in one another,
as the Holy One delights in us.*

May we open the gates of our souls, that Wisdom may enter,
making us friends of God and one another.

*We open in this time to the
transforming power of the Spirit.*

You are welcome at this table if you have a little faith, a lot of faith, absolutely no faith,
or are of another faith. This is the Table of the Christ, and the welcome is wide!

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[... to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

Each morning brings us a newness
that we but need to step into.
It can wash us,
lift us,
heal us,
hold us
just as each of us has need.

As we give from our financial resources this morning,
to continue the work of this church
may we be open to the power that lies within us.
May we be full with a confidence in our strength.
May we move from empty routines

to the fullness of life
that we might live God's dream.

You will find information for online giving in your programs and appearing on your screens at home. Our Hospitality Team will also come forward now to receive your offerings. Thank you for your ongoing generosity through the resources, time, and talents you bring to strengthen our community to be the Love of the Divine in the world.

Offertory

Art Thou Troubled?
Tiffany Ho, *Soprano*, Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organ*

G. F. Handel

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

Holy One, as we give our offerings
may our eyes be open
to see you in all the colors of creation
as you use our generosity to awaken us
to a new sense of awe and wonder.

May we know you, O God, as the sacred presence that is real to us.
May we know you, O God, as the one who is the source of inspiration
and courage as you keep calling us forward
to share your dream for our world.

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

Amen.

Please be seated

[Michael and Laura center chancel]

Words of Blessing

ML

May the God you see in all the colors of creation
awaken in you a sense of awe and wonder.

May the God who is a sacred presence be real to you.

May the God who is the source of inspiration and courage
keep calling you forward.

May your God go with you and bless you.

May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

Choral Response

Peace, Be Still

Shawn Kirchner

Peace, be still, and know that I am God. Peace, be still, and know that I am

Peace, be still, and know. Peace, be still. Peace, be. Peace, peace, peace

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

Wake Now My Senses

SLANE

Wake now my senses, and hear the Earth call,
feel the deep power of being in all,
keep with the web of creation your vow,
giving, receiving, as love shows us how.

Wake now my reason, reach out for the new,
join with each trav'ler who quests for the true,
honor the beauty and wisdom of time,
transcend our limits and touch the sublime.

Wake now my vision, the dream we hold dear,
brighten our pathway with radiance here,
journey together with all who will share,
love for the planet transformed by our care.

--lyrics Mikelson

[Laura center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music

